Ishkhan Khchoian

Legal Counsel — contracts, disputes & cross-border operations

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Armenian (native) · English (C1) · Russian (C2)

PROFILE

Six years of legal work across three very different environments: civil and contract practice at a Bar Association, a state arbitration court from the inside as a judge's associate, and U.S. immigration practice at two American firms. For an international company that combination is the practical one — I can paper the commercial agreements, see a dispute coming early enough to settle it cheaply, and take on the cross-border employment and immigration work that most in-house teams end up outsourcing. I have also worked in-house before, as administrator and legal counsel to a construction and retail group, so I am used to being the only lawyer in the room and being asked for an answer rather than a memo.

One interview is enough — give me 30 minutes and a real problem from your team, and you'll see how I work.

WHAT I CAN TAKE OFF YOUR DESK

- **Contracts.** Civil-law contract analysis, drafting and claims — six years, first at a Bar Association supporting a trade and construction organisation, then in-house at LLC "SIS", where the contracts I reviewed were the ones I then had to deliver against.
- **Disputes, seen from the bench.** As judge's associate at the Arbitration Court of the Magadan Region I drafted judicial acts and managed case materials across **200+ parallel cases and 30+ hearings a week**, covering three roles at once. Knowing how a commercial dispute actually gets decided changes how you write the clause that prevents it.
- **U.S. immigration and relocation.** Owned complex filings end to end — **O-1B, EB-3, E-2** — up to **12 in parallel**, from intake and strategy through evidence to submission. Directly useful to an Armenian-based employer moving staff, founders or contractors across borders.
- **Legal operations.** I rewrote internal workflows, templates and checklists at M&M and they became the team standard; at Shamayev I built and taught the **Paralegal Academy**, whose materials went on to serve **50+ people**. Legal teams lose more time to bad process than to hard questions.
- **Managing legal staff.** Coordinated **8 paralegals**, reviewed their output against defined standards, and deputised for the team lead at Shamayev.
- **Three working languages.** Armenian native, Russian C2, English C1 — drafting, negotiating and client-facing work in all three, which for an international company removes a translation layer.
- **Commercial literacy.** Tenders, procurement, budgets and delivery schedules across 15+ projects, plus U.S.-standards project management training in 2026. I know what a "no" from legal costs the business.

LEGAL EXPERIENCE

Freelance — legal & project work · PM training Feb 2026 – present

- Legal: IP assignment for works of popular musicians; corporate structure for a crypto trader; advised on opening a crypto-exchange office in Armenia.
- Projects: COO of the **SayWhen.am** startup (AI voice agents); business research for a water production line; CPA/affiliate manager (under NDA); sale of family real estate; designed a US client-acquisition pilot for **Karas Systems** (B2B go-to-market consultancy).

Senior Case Manager — M&M Document Preparation (U.S. immigration) Jun 2025 – Feb 2026

- Owned the firm's most complex and highest-value filings end to end — intake, strategy, evidence, submission — up to **12 in parallel** under immovable statutory deadlines.
- Coordinated **8 paralegals**; escalation point on the hard problems.
- Rebuilt internal workflows, templates and checklists into the team's working standard.

Paralegal, autonomous caseload — Bloomrich Law Firm Nov 2023 – Aug 2024

- Hired on the strength of previous results and given full autonomy over caseload, documentation and client communication.

Senior Paralegal — Shamayev Business Law Corp. Feb 2023 – Oct 2023

- Trusted with the firm's key cases; deputised for the team lead.
- Designed and delivered the **Paralegal Academy** — curriculum, materials and teaching; used by **50+ paralegals**.

Judge's Associate — Arbitration Court of the Magadan Region Nov 2021 – Dec 2022

- Drafted judicial acts, managed case materials and kept document flow moving across **200+ parallel cases** and **30+ hearings a week**.
- Covered **three roles simultaneously** — judge's associate, court specialist and court secretary — normally held by three separate people. Written reference available.

Assistant Lawyer — Bar Association Dec 2019 – Aug 2021

- Analysed civil-law contracts and prepared claims; provided ongoing legal support to a trade and construction organisation.

Administrator / Legal Counsel — LLC "SIS" (construction & retail group) Jun 2015 – Sep 2019

- In-house legal support alongside operations: contracts with contractors and suppliers, procurement and transport arrangements, tenders, recruitment and sales.
- Construction projects continued under my responsibility through 2022.

ADJACENT EXPERIENCE

Event / Project Manager — Hosq Corp. Jan 2025 – Jun 2025

- Vendor contracts, logistics and on-site operations for live events of 100–3,000 people.

Project Manager — Qanon Construction Aug 2024 – Dec 2024

- Client communication, scope agreement, timelines and follow-through.

EDUCATION & TRAINING

- **Project management, U.S. standards** — "Project Management with a U.S. Perspective: Skills for Global Success" — Yerevan American Corner, a joint program of the U.S. Embassy Yerevan and the City Central Isahakyan Library; 21 Jul – 21 Aug 2026, in person, Certificate of Achievement.
- **Project Management** — PM Club, 2023 (52 academic hours, online).
- **Bachelor of Law** — North-Eastern State University, 2021.
- **Civil Law, Faculty of Law** — St. Petersburg State University, 2016.

SCOPE NOTE

My degree and court experience are Russian-jurisdiction; my U.S. work was immigration practice at American firms. I am not admitted to the Armenian bar, so I am applying for in-house counsel and legal-operations roles rather than court representation in Armenia — and I am happy to work alongside outside counsel where local admission is required.

ALSO

- **Highload++** (700 attendees) — organising team, led a crew of 12; performance bonus, certificate.
- **Ethos Foundation** — HQ coordinator, 2023–2024; aid to ~100 families a day; written commendation.